OSCP Journey – Seventh Week (Exam)

Published by Arvandy on August 18, 2018

Date: 12 August – 18 August 2018

Amazing Week! My exam scheduled on Wednesday, 15 August 2018 15:00 (Asia/Jakarta). One day before the exam, I take a rest from exploiting any machines and just making sure all the scripts, tools, notes and provisions are ready to use. I also prepare the contingency plan such as second internet connection and machine that ready to use in case some issues occurred in the middle of the exam.

I simplified my enum script just to run the Nmap and OneTwoPunch tools. Nmap used to run a quick scan using -sV and -sC flag while the OneTwoPunch will run full TCP and UDP port scanning. I tried the script on the lab machines and its working fine. Single host scan took around 15-20 minutes to finish. There are five machines in the exam network with two 25 point machines, two 20 point machines, and one 10 point machine. The minimal points to pass is 70.

This is the exam plan:
15:00 – 15:15 = Check VPN connection, read exam instructions carefully and making note
15:15 – 17:00 = Exploiting Machine 1 (25 Points)
17:10 – 19:00 = Exploiting Machine 2 (10 Points)

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19:00 – 20:00 = Break
20:00 – 23:00 = Exploiting Machine 3 (20 Points)
23:00 – 04:30 = Sleep
04:30 – 07:00 = Exploiting Machine 4 (20 Points)
07:00 – 08:00 = Break
08:00 – 11:00 = Exploiting Machine 5 (25 Points)
11:00 – 12:00 = Break
12:00 – 14:30 = Final check and gather necessary documentation

This is the actual:

15:00 – 15:10 = Check VPN connection, read exam instructions carefully and making note
15:10 – 15:45 = Successfully exploiting machine 1 (25 Points)
15:45 – 15:55 = Ten minutes short break
15:55 – 16:10 = Successfully exploiting machine 2 (10 Points)
16:10 – 16:20 = Ten minutes short break
16:20 – 17:00 = Working on machine 3 (20 points, stuck)
17:00 – 18:00 = Successfully exploiting machine 4 (25 Points)
18:00 – 18:10 = Collect necessary screenshots for machine 4
18:10 – 18:20 = Another ten minutes short break
18:20 – 19:00 = Back working on machine 3 (Got access to certain service but no shell)
19:00 – 20:00 = One hour break for dinner
20:00 – 20:42 = Successfully exploiting machine 5 (20 Points)
20:42 – 21:00 = Collect necessary screenshots for machine 5
21:00 – 21:10 = Another ten minutes short break
21:10 – 23:00 = Working on machine 3 (Found another hidden service and privilege escalation vector but still no shell)
23:00 – 04:30 = Sleep

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04:30 – 07:00 = Keep working on machine 3 (Nightmare, lead to nowhere)
07:00 – 08:00 = One hour break for breakfast
08:00 – 09:30 = Decided to skip the last machine and focus on triple checks the exam guidelines and gather necessary documentation screenshots
09:30 – 12:00 = Going to college to finish some administration stuff
12:00 – 14:45 = Start doing the exam reports

Overall the exam machines are not too hard but a little bit tricky with a few rabbit holes. Keep calm and stay focus. The exam did not require any advanced techniques or exploitation. All that you learned from the course and lab will get you through it. Don't get stuck too long on one machine when you still have other machines to exploits.

Before the exam, I read a lot of exams write up that a bit intimidating where some students fail the exam even after finish all the machines in the lab. Personally, I think the intimidating one is the exam rules itself, not the exam machines. The exam rules are very very strict and even if you success exploiting all the machines in the exam, you still will fail if you didn't follow the exam guidelines. That's one of the reasons I choose to skip the last machine and focusing on the documentation report.

I sent the exam and lab reports around 22:30 and get the receipt confirmation on 00:25 which states that the exams results will be received within 3 business days. This waiting time slowly killing me. I keep asking myself "did I break any exam rules? did my documentation report good enough? did I make any typing mistakes?". The anxiety on waiting for the exam results far worse than doing the actual exam. I feel ready and on-fire when doing the exam.

Finally, at 18 August 2018 01:29, the email results arrived. It's faster than I expected. I passed the exam and officially obtained the Offensive Security Certified Professional (OSCP) certification. My first professional certification! OffSec did not provide the soft copy of the certificate and the hard copy will be delivered via DHL courier to my address. They tell me to expect the delivery within **60 days** (Way too long but I hope it will be faster than that).

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Penetration Testing with Kali Linux - OSCP Certification Exam Results 1 messag

From: orders 1:29 AM

To: Arvandy

oscp.zip (272.9 KB) Download | Briefcase | Remove

Dear Arvandy,

We are happy to inform you that you have successfully completed the Penetration Testing with Kali Linux certification exam and have obtained your Offensive Security Certified Professional (OSCP) certification.

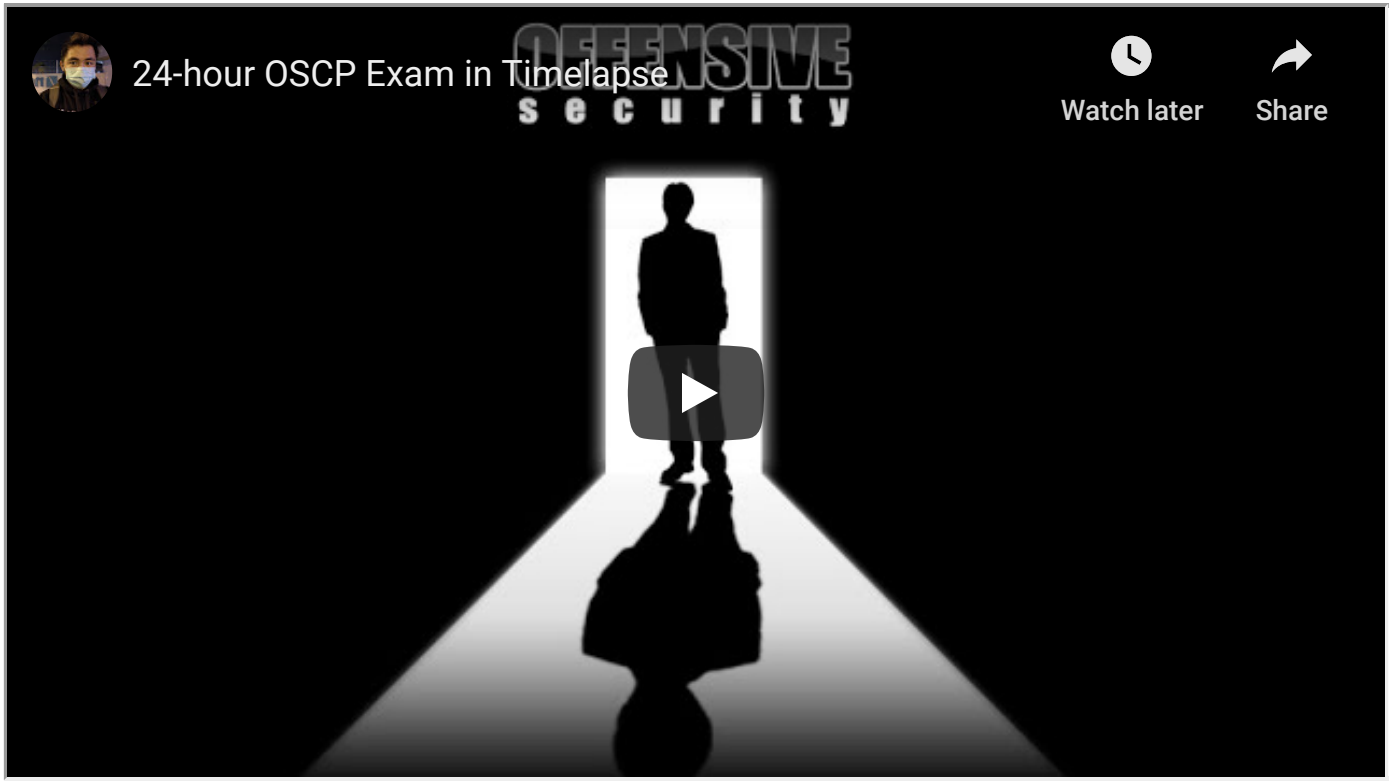
Listed below is your name as it will appear on your printed certification. If any changes are required, please let us know right away at orders@offensive-security.com.

Arvandy

I didn’t write much about the technical things since there are a lot of very good resources out there. You need to learn to do your own research. Google-fu is one of the must-have skills when doing PWK course. By simply typing “OSCP cheat sheet” on Google, you will find a lot of good resources.

Since this is once in a lifetime experiences, I decide to record my exam process in timelapse.

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I see a lot of people preparing for OSCP by learning about the operating system, programming, networking, etc and forgetting to actually learn to exploit vulnerable machines. It's not wrong (I also did that at first), But for me, all of that not good enough if you did not know the techniques or the attack vectors. You can learn those stuff along the way when exploiting the vulnerable machines. The best thing to prepare is by actually start exploiting vulnerable machines, get comfortable enough and equip yourself with a lot of different attack vectors. The programming stuff required also only the basic one, you just need to able to read and modify the exploit code slightly.

How to get such things? If you have a lot of time you can try exploiting vulnerable machines in VulnHub and HTB. At first, it surely will be hard and frustrating since you will encounter a lot of new things. But if you really like this field, you will keep going and

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working on it, persevere, be committed and consistent! Everyone starts somewhere, don't be ashamed of asking for a hint but make sure not to rely too much on it. *Every master was once a beginner. Every pro was once an amateur.* There's no magic button. We just need to keep striving!

For people that don't have much time to dedicate on it, simply watch IppSec videos and read the VulnHub write-up on your free time. You will have a lot of attack vectors in your pocket that will be applicable in PWK lab and exam.

The other important things are the mindset and methodology. If we already set our mind to tackle this course, dedicate our time, commit and consistent about it, I am sure it's achievable even if we didn't have any pen-testing experiences. I also new in this field, didn't have any certification and professional pen-testing experiences. For the methodology and tips, I post some of them on the weekly update in this blog including my OSCP preparation. ~~I will try to wrap it up (preparation, lab and exam) into a single post in another one or two weeks,~~ and at last, happy hacking!

OSCP

10 Comments



Minly

AUGUST 19, 2018

Congrats for your achievement. Good job!!!

REPLY

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Arvandy

AUGUST 22, 2018

Thank you for supporting!

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quincyntuli

AUGUST 19, 2018

I am very happy for you. I write on the 10th.

REPLY



Arvandy

AUGUST 22, 2018

Thank you quincyntuli.

Wish you all the best for your upcoming exam.

Let me know if I can be of any help.

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Anand Kumar

AUGUST 20, 2018

WOW… Congrats Sir, for yr Achievement …!!!
Really inspired and Motivated , Your all lines of Sentences…!!
Thanks to Share Yr Experiences..!!
and I hope U will also Provide me Some Better Content Which will helps me to Improve my Knowledge.

REPLY



Arvandy

AUGUST 22, 2018

Thank you, glad you like it.
I will try!

REPLY



Yunara

AUGUST 24, 2018

Wow, congratulations!! I hope I can contact you directly about the path to take the OSCP, I'm also currently enrolling in Master's Degree in IT(but there is no InfoSec option at my University T_T) after graduated from Bachelor's Degree in CS(basic front-end backe-end programming, simple networking, etc..). I wanted to take OSCP directly but I'm scared if it is way too advanced that I couldn't learn the

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fundamentals of penetration testing (I am also blind in InfoSec field). I'm currently stuck between two options, whether to take eJPT -> eCPPT -> OSCP or directly OSCP. If I take OSCP directly, how can I be sure that I have secured all of the Penetration Testing fundamentals? Will I be able to demonstrate skills later on, maybe on HackTheBox? I really appreciate your time replying my comment. Terima kasih 🙂

REPLY



Arvandy

AUGUST 24, 2018

Thank You Yunara.I believe there is no right or wrong path to take OSCP. Everyone has their own path that suitable for them. Overall my path is VulnHub, HackTheBox and OSCP.

I didn't know much about eJPT and eCPPT but I heard the course materials and labs are good and helpful in preparing for OSCP. If you already know some basics, eCPPT -> OSCP can be the third option. If you want to take OSCP directly, make sure you are comfortable enough exploiting vulnerable machines so you won't waste a lot of lab times. Time commitment also important too.

I think OSCP will give you basic fundamentals on pentesting and yes it applicable on HackTheBox. But did it give ALL the fundamentals? honestly I don't know the answer.
Hope it could help.

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Abdullah

AUGUST 31, 2018

Hi ARVANDY…

I Loved Your Post,

Thanks For Sharing Your Experience Of Your OSCP Journey,
#Your Exam Timelapse Video is also very Nice 🙂

YOU TRIED HARDER!!!

REPLY



Paul

FEBRUARY 22, 2019

Well done Mate!
Been reading up your stuff, and hard work paid off.
Conrats again.

REPLY

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